PulseReel Circuit Breaker: V1 PRD

Detect fast-mobilizing reels early, slow them in proportion, keep a person in the loop. Prepared 6 Nov 2026 by Saadurya K V. Tags: S public source (page 9) · C calculated from stated inputs · V V1 setting (our design choice; final values set by the Phase 0 backtest)

V1 at a glance.

- **What we build:** a Mobilization Score (0–100) for fast-rising reels, a four-step response ladder (Watch, Label, Slow, Hold) where every cut ends on a timer, a reviewer console, and an audit log.
- **Where the line is:** popularity and political topic never reduce reach. Reach is cut (Slow or Hold) only when a reel does **all three**: spreads unusually fast, asks people to gather at a time and place, and makes an unverified first-hand claim of harm.
- **What V1 does not do:** decide whether an incident is real, remove content, strike or ban creators.

Step	Score	Gate that must also be true	What users and reviewers see	Ends when
L0 Normal	0–39	none	No change.	n/a
L1 Watch	40–54	none (also the cap for a reel with no content signal)	Reel on the analyst watchlist. Viewers see nothing.	Score under 40 for 2 h
L2 Label	55–69	at least 1 content signal (call to gather or unverified claim)	Label under the reel and a one-time pause before sharing. Reach unchanged.	12 h, or score under 50 for 2 h
L3 Slow	70–84	both content signals	New recommendations capped at 50% of the previous hour's rate. Label stays. Review within 2 h.	Steps down to L2 after 4 h unless a reviewer confirms
L4 Hold	85–100	both content signals	No new recommendations. Reel stays on the creator's profile, to followers, in search and by link. Review within 30 min.	Steps down to L3 after 60 min unless a reviewer confirms

All numbers in this table are V1 settings V, with reasons in FR1–FR3 (page 4). The Phase 0 backtest (page 3) sets the final values.

1. PROBLEM STATEMENT

Context. PulseReel's 60M users are all aged 18–25. In India, short video reaches 588M people, about 61% of internet users S[7]. PulseReel's recommender ranks reels by how fast people engage. That works for a dance trend, but it cannot tell a reel people *watch* from a reel that makes people *gather*. One unverified "incident" reel therefore became a nationwide protest movement in 72 hours, and the only options were full amplification or removal.

If the reel is false, amplifying it risks panic and violence: in 2018 more than two dozen people in India were beaten to death by mobs after rumours spread on WhatsApp S[2]. If it is true, cutting it silences a legitimate protest. Youth-led protests can move fast: in Nepal in Sept 2025 they went from the first street protest on 8 Sept to the prime minister's resignation on 9 Sept S[6]. Regulators are watching, and a blunter fix will be imposed if PulseReel does not build its own.

Problem statement. Trust & Safety analysts and PulseReel's 18–25 viewers need the platform to respond differently to reels that organise people than to reels that entertain them. The ranker counts speed but is blind to what a reel asks viewers to do, and the only responses are full reach or removal, so decisions come late and are blunt. The result is that an unverified call to gather can scale to a nationwide movement in 72 hours, while a wrong cut harms real creators and organisers.

Root causes this PRD fixes (5 Whys, short form)

Why did the reel scale?	The ranker rewards engagement speed, so a fast reel gets more reach.
Why was it not slowed?	**Root cause 1:** no signal in the ranker captures what a reel asks people to do (gather at a place and time) or whether it claims harm with no source.
Why was it only slowed or removed late?	**Root cause 2:** the only responses are full reach or removal, so nobody acts until they are sure, and by then the reel is at scale. The fix needs several steps with timers.

What a mobilizing reel does that a dance trend never does

	Dance trend	Mobilizing reel
Asks the viewer to	copy a move	show up at a place and time
Claim	none	first-hand claim of harm or injustice, with no source
Who shares	one interest community	many unrelated communities and states within hours
Where it goes	reposts inside the app	forwards out to chat apps
Cost of a wrong call	none	panic or violence if missed; a silenced protest if over-cut

These differences are drawn from the brief's case. The Phase 0 backtest on 200 labelled reels (page 3) tests each one.

Who gets hurt if the system is wrong. Missed reel: people in the affected city (safety), and PulseReel (regulation). **Over-cut reel:** creators and organisers whose legitimate content loses reach, and trust in PulseReel. 18–25 matters because every PulseReel user is in the group that led Nepal's protests S[6]; it is an analogy, not the same mechanism.

2. PAIN POINTS

#	Pain point	Who feels it	Evidence
1	**The ranker is blind to intent.** It counts speed, not what a reel asks people to do.	T&S analysts	The brief's reel reached a nationwide movement in 72 hours with the ranker working as designed.
2	**Only two states exist:** full reach or removal.	T&S, Legal	Facebook's review system cuts distribution while a post is checked and does not remove it [5]. PulseReel has no such middle step.
3	**Waiting for facts is too slow.**	Viewers, T&S	On Twitter, true stories took about 6x longer than false ones to reach 1,500 people; false stories were about 70% more likely to be shared [1]. Platform differs; direction is the point.
4	**Forwards leave the app,** where PulseReel cannot follow them.	Viewers in the affected area	WhatsApp capped forwards at 5 chats in India in 2018 after mob killings [2], and in Apr 2020 cut "highly forwarded" messages to one chat. It reported a 70% drop (company figure, method not published) [3].
5	**No friction at the share step.**	Viewers	A Twitter prompt made users 40% more likely to open an article before sharing it [4] (company figure).
6	**No record regulators can inspect.**	Legal	The brief states that scrutiny of algorithmic amplification is rising.
7	**Creators cannot challenge a reach cut.**	Creators	No PulseReel data yet. Confirmed in Week 1 with 10 creator interviews.

3. USER STORIES

Persona	High-level story	Sub stories
T&S analyst	Catch mobilizing reels before they reach scale and decide in minutes.	• As a T&S analyst, I want a ranked watchlist so that I review the most urgent reel first. • As a T&S analyst, I want to see why a reel scored high so that I can decide in under 5 minutes. • As a T&S analyst, I want to undo any action in one click so that a mistake does not last.
Viewer, 18–25	Know when a fast-spreading reel is unverified, without being told what to believe.	• As a viewer, I want a plain label on a fast-spreading reel so that I do not mistake it for confirmed fact. • As a viewer, I want a short pause before I forward such a reel so that I can choose with the facts in view. • As a viewer, I want to report a reel that worries me, using neutral reasons, so that a person can look at it.
Creator	Understand any limit on my reel and challenge it.	• As a creator, I want to be told quickly what happened to my reel and when it ends so that I know why my reach changed. • As a creator, I want to appeal and get a decision within a day so that a wrong call does not stand.
Legal and Compliance lead	Prove what the system did and why.	• As a Compliance lead, I want a complete exportable log of every event so that I can answer a regulator in 24 hours. • As a Compliance lead, I want to see monthly counts of actions and the share overturned so that I can show the system is proportionate.
Policy lead	Tune the line safely.	• As a Policy lead, I want threshold changes to need a backtest and a second approver so that the line cannot drift quietly. • As a Policy lead, I want to see what the system would have done in shadow mode so that I can trust it before it acts.

4. MENTAL MODEL

Working view of each persona, confirmed in Week 1 with 5 T&S analysts, 10 creators and 10 viewers.

Persona	How they think today	Words they use	What it means for design
Viewer	"If it is on my feed and many people shared it, it is probably true and happening now."	"trending", "everyone is sharing", "forward kar do"	Say "unverified", never "false". A verdict from the app will not be believed and is not our claim.
Creator	"Views are my income and my proof it worked. Less reach means I was shadowbanned."	"shadowban", "reach dropped", "flop"	Always tell the creator the reason and the end time.
T&S analyst	"Volume is normal. Trouble is when a reel asks people to act. I need a short list, not a firehose."	"queue", "SLA", "escalate"	Ranked list with reasons visible.
Compliance	"If a regulator asks, show me what was seen, what we did, who approved, and when."	"audit trail", "due diligence"	One event, one record, exportable.

Today's workaround: analysts hear about a reel from user complaints or the comms team, then escalate by hand. There is no early-warning list.

5. DESIGN REQUIREMENTS

Written for designers: what a user must be able to do and see, not how the system works inside.

D1. Viewer sees the label and the share pause

User story. As a viewer, I want to see when a fast-spreading reel is unverified so that I do not mistake it for confirmed fact.

A user has successfully used this feature when they can:

- **See the label:** a one-line label under the reel, "Spreading fast · Not verified", in a neutral colour (not red).
- **Understand it:** tap "Why am I seeing this?" and read two plain lines in Hindi or English (spreading fast; claim not yet verified). It never says true or false.
- **Keep watching:** playback is never blocked or delayed by the label.
- **Choose at the share step:** tapping Share shows a one-time pause ("This reel is spreading fast and is not verified. Send anyway?") with two equal buttons, "Send anyway" and "Cancel". Sending costs at most one extra tap.
- **See it clear:** the label disappears when the step ends, with no notification.

D2. Viewer reports a reel

User story. As a viewer, I want to report a reel that worries me so that a person can look at it.

A user has successfully used this feature when they can:

- **Find it fast:** open the report from the "..." menu in 2 taps or fewer.
- **Choose a neutral reason:** "Claim looks unverified", "Call to gather looks fake", or "Could cause panic". There is no "I disagree" option.
- **Get honest feedback:** a confirmation says "Thanks. Reports help us review. They do not remove reels."
- **Not see the crowd:** the number of other reports is never shown, so groups cannot coordinate. One report per reel per account.

D3. Analyst reviews in one screen

User story. As a T&S analyst, I want to see why a reel scored high and act on it in one screen so that I decide in under 5 minutes.

A user has successfully used this feature when they can:

- **Work a ranked list:** reels sorted by score, each showing its step, time in that step, and a countdown to automatic step-down.
- **See the evidence together:** the video, the score with six signal bars, views per hour against normal for the same age, the caption and speech with place and time phrases highlighted, and report groups.
- **Spot gaming:** a banner appears when 50% or more of the reports look coordinated.
- **Decide in 3 clicks:** Confirm, Step down, Release to normal, or Escalate to Legal, each with a reason from a short list plus free text.
- **Undo:** reverse any decision in one click.

D4. Creator is told and can appeal

User story. As a creator, I want to know what happened to my reel and challenge it so that a wrong call does not stand.

A user has successfully used this feature when they can:

- **Get a clear notice:** within 5 minutes of Slow or Hold, an in-app message gives the reason in plain words, the end time, and says "Not removed. No strike."
- **Appeal in 2 taps:** add up to 300 characters.
- **Track it:** status moves Received, Under review, Decided, with a reason, within 24 hours.
- **Keep their audience:** followers still see the reel throughout.

6. FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

Scope: the smallest set that would have caught the brief's reel. Phase 1 (weeks 3–6) ships **FR1, FR2, FR5, FR6, FR9**: score, ladder, reach limits, reviewer console and audit log. In Phase 1 the ladder runs in **shadow mode** (it logs what it would do) and analysts apply Slow or Hold by hand. Phase 2 (weeks 7–12) adds automation: **FR3, FR4, FR7, FR8**. Not in V1: removing content, strikes or bans, fact-checking, languages beyond Hindi and English, chat-app forwards.

Phase 0	Weeks 0–2. Backtest on 200 labelled past reels (V 50 mobilization-related and 150 ordinary top-velocity). Launch gate: catch at least 45 of 50 at L2 or above, and at most 3 of 150 ordinary reels at L3 or above. Three false alarms in 150 reels is 2%, and the 95% upper bound is 5.7% C, so the gate is deliberately strict.

FR1. Score fast-rising reels every 5 minutes · Phase 1

User story. As the T&S system owner, I want only fast-rising reels scored so that scoring stays cheap and every score has a reason.

Requirement. Every 5 minutes, for each reel under 24 hours old whose views in the last 60 minutes are at or above the 99.5th percentile of reels of the same age over the past 7 days, compute a Mobilization Score from the six signals below and store each signal.

Acceptance criteria

GIVEN a reel is below the 99.5th percentile **WHEN** the scoring run executes **THEN** no score is computed and no signal data is stored.

GIVEN a reel at the 99.9th percentile, in 8 interest clusters and 10 states, asking people to gather and claiming harm with no source **WHEN** the run executes **THEN** a record with all six signal values, the total and the model version is written within 60 seconds of the run start.

GIVEN a reel has maximum spread, cross-community and share signals but both content signals at 0 **WHEN** the run executes **THEN** the total is at most 55 (65 once reports count) and FR2 caps the step at L1.

Comments. Thresholds are V1 settings V: the 99.5th percentile keeps the scored set to about 1 reel in 200. Phase 0 tunes them.

FR1 signals and points (total 100)

Signal (points)	Full points when	Half points when	Why this signal
Spread velocity (25)	views per hour at or above the 99.9th percentile for same-age reels	15 points at the 99.5th percentile	Speed is what the ranker already sees.
Cross-community spread (20)	in the first 3 h, views from 8 or more interest clusters and 10 or more states	10 points at 5 clusters and 6 states	A dance trend stays in about 3 clusters V.
Call to gather (20)	caption, on-screen text or speech holds a place, a time and an action word ("aaj 6 baje India Gate aao")	10 points for place and action word	The one thing a dance trend never asks.
Unverified harm claim (15)	first-hand claim of violence, death, police action or injustice, from an account that is not a verified news account and gives no source link	none	Separates a rumour from reporting.
External share rate (10)	shares to other apps per 1,000 views at 2x or more the same-age median	none	Mobilization travels to chat apps S[2][3].
Viewer reports (10)	30 or more independent report groups (FR7)	none; counts as 0 for the first 30 days	A crowd signal that is easy to game, so small.

FR2. Map score to step, with gates · Phase 1 (logged), Phase 2 (automatic)

User story. As an analyst, I want a popular reel with no call to gather never to be throttled so that the system never acts on popularity or topic alone.

Requirement. Map the score to the step in the ladder (page 1). A step needs the score in its band on 2 runs in a row (10 minutes) **and** its gate: L2 needs at least one content signal above 0; L3 and L4 need both. If the band is higher than the gate allows, apply the highest step the gate allows.

Acceptance criteria

GIVEN a reel scores 72 on two runs in a row, call to gather is 20 and unverified claim is 15 **WHEN** the second run completes **THEN** the reel moves to L3 Slow and the step start time is stored.

GIVEN a reel scores 85 on two runs in a row (velocity 25, cross-community 20, call to gather 20, share rate 10, reports 10) and unverified claim is 0 **WHEN** the second run completes **THEN** the reel moves to L2 Label, the highest step its gate allows, and the log shows 'capped by gate'.

GIVEN a reel scores 65, the most it can reach with both content signals at 0 **WHEN** the run completes **THEN** the reel stays at L1 Watch and no viewer-facing change is made.

Comments. Reports can never move a reel above L1 on their own, because they are capped at 10 points and are not a content signal. V The 10-minute hold trades 5 minutes of speed for fewer false alarms.

FR3. Every cut ends on a timer · Phase 2

User story. As a creator, I want a limit on my reel to end on its own if nobody confirms it so that a missed review never becomes a permanent cut.

Requirement. L4 steps down to L3 after 60 minutes, L3 to L2 after 4 hours, and L2 to L0 after 12 hours, unless a reviewer confirms. A confirm resets the timer: L4 to 4 hours, L3 to 12 hours. Total time at L3 or L4 is at most 24 hours unless a second reviewer also confirms. On every step-down, page the on-call reviewer.

Acceptance criteria

GIVEN a reel has been at L4 for 60 minutes with no confirm **WHEN** the timer ends **THEN** the reel moves to L3 and the on-call reviewer is paged, and an 'auto step-down' record is written, and the creator notice is updated.

GIVEN a reviewer confirms L4 at minute 45 **WHEN** the confirm is saved **THEN** the timer resets to 4 hours.

GIVEN a reel has spent 24 hours at L3 or L4 with one reviewer **WHEN** the 24-hour mark is reached **THEN** the step drops to L2 unless a second reviewer has confirmed.

Comments. Trade-off: if no one reviews, a harmful reel regains some reach after 60 minutes. We accept this, because a cut with no human behind it is the unfairness regulators and creators will not tolerate. The page to on-call limits the gap.

FR4. Label and share pause · Phase 2

User story. As a viewer, I want a plain label and a short pause before forwarding so that I can choose with the facts in view.

Requirement. At L2 or above, show the label under the reel and a one-time share pause per viewer per reel, in the viewer's language (Hindi or English).

Acceptance criteria

GIVEN a reel is at L2 or above **WHEN** a viewer opens it **THEN** the label shows within 1 second of video start **AND THEN** playback is not interrupted.

GIVEN a viewer taps Share on a labelled reel for the first time **WHEN** the share sheet would open **THEN** the pause shows once, and 'Send anyway' completes the share in 1 tap.

Comments. Test: reels in the 55–69 band are randomised 50/50 label vs no label (page 7). L3 and L4 never have a control group.

FR5. Reach limits for Slow and Hold · Phase 1 (by hand), Phase 2 (automatic)

User story. As an analyst, I want Slow and Hold to cut new recommendations and nothing else so that the reel is slowed, not erased.

Requirement. L3: cap new impressions in For You, Explore and Trending at 50% of the reel's impressions in the hour before L3 began, and send no promotional pushes. L4: 0 new impressions in those surfaces. In both, the reel stays on the creator's profile, to followers, in search and by link. No existing view is removed. Propagation takes 60 seconds or less.

Acceptance criteria

GIVEN a reel was getting 100,000 impressions an hour when L3 began **WHEN** L3 is active **THEN** new impressions in the three surfaces are at most 50,000 an hour.

GIVEN a reel is at L4 **WHEN** a follower opens the creator's profile, and a stranger opens a direct link **THEN** both can play the reel **AND THEN** it receives 0 new impressions in For You, Explore and Trending.

Comments. The 50% cap is a V1 setting V. WhatsApp's one-chat cap cut highly forwarded messages by 70% on the company's figure S[3]; we start milder because a wrong cut harms a real creator.

FR6. Reviewer queue and console · Phase 1

User story. As an analyst, I want L3 and L4 reels in one ranked queue with the evidence on one screen so that I decide in minutes.

Requirement. Create a queue item when a reel reaches L3 (SLA 2 hours) or L4 (SLA 30 minutes, page the on-call). Show the console in D3. Every decision needs a reason. L4 not opened in 15 minutes goes to the team lead.

Acceptance criteria

GIVEN a reel reaches L4 **WHEN** the step is applied **THEN** the on-call reviewer is paged within 60 seconds and the item shows a 30-minute SLA clock.

GIVEN a reviewer chooses Release **WHEN** they submit without a reason **THEN** the decision is rejected until a reason is chosen.

GIVEN 50% or more of a reel's reports fall inside a 5-minute window **WHEN** the reviewer opens it **THEN** the 'possible coordinated reports' banner is shown.

FR7. Capture reports and resist gaming · Phase 1 capture only; weight on after 30 days

User story. As a Policy lead, I want reports to count only as independent signals so that a group cannot throttle a reel it dislikes.

Requirement. Accept one report per account per reel with the three reasons in D2. Count a report only if the account is 30 or more days old and has watched 20 or more reels in the last 7 days. Accounts that share a device, an IP block, or 3 or more followed accounts form one **report group**, and a group counts once. If 50% or more of a reel's reports arrive in 5 minutes from groups with a common source, weight them x0.2. A reporter with 5 or more reports of which over 60% were overturned has weight 0. Reports are worth at most 10 points and cannot lift a reel above L1.

Acceptance criteria

GIVEN 500 accounts that follow the same 3 accounts report one reel within 5 minutes **WHEN** the next run executes **THEN** they count as 1 report group, the reports signal is 0, and a 'possible brigading' ticket is opened.

GIVEN a reel's only raised signal is reports at 10 points **WHEN** the run executes **THEN** the reel stays at L0 and no step is applied.

GIVEN a red-team test with 500 colluding accounts on a test reel **WHEN** the test runs weekly **THEN** the score rises by at most 3 points.

Comments. All limits are V1 settings V. Phase 1 collects reports with weight 0 for 30 days to measure the real brigading baseline before they count.

FR8. Creator notice and appeal · Phase 2

User story. As a creator, I want to be told what happened and to appeal so that a wrong call is fixed fast.

Requirement. On L3 or L4, send the D4 notice within 5 minutes. An appeal goes to a reviewer who did not make the first decision, answered within 24 hours.

Acceptance criteria

GIVEN L3 or L4 has been applied **WHEN** 5 minutes pass **THEN** the creator has a notice with the reason, the end time and the words 'Not removed. No strike'.

GIVEN an appeal is overturned **WHEN** the reviewer submits **THEN** the reel returns to L0 within 60 seconds and the creator is notified.

FR9. Audit log · Phase 1

User story. As a Compliance lead, I want every event recorded and exportable so that I can answer a regulator in 24 hours.

Requirement. Write an append-only record for each score, step change, report weighting, reviewer decision and threshold edit, with time, actor, before and after, model version and reason. Chain the records by hash so tampering shows. Export in CSV or JSON within 24 hours of a request. Retain for 3 years (V, Legal to confirm). A threshold change needs a backtest report attached and two approvers (Policy and Legal).

Acceptance criteria

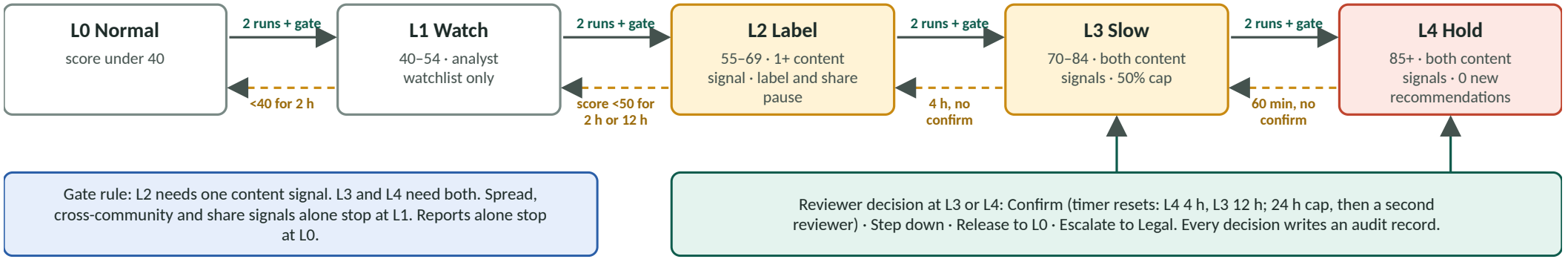
GIVEN any step changes **WHEN** it is applied **THEN** one record exists with every field above, and the hash chain verifies.

GIVEN Legal requests the events for one reel **WHEN** the request is made **THEN** a CSV with all of its records is delivered within 24 hours.

7. Solution User Flow

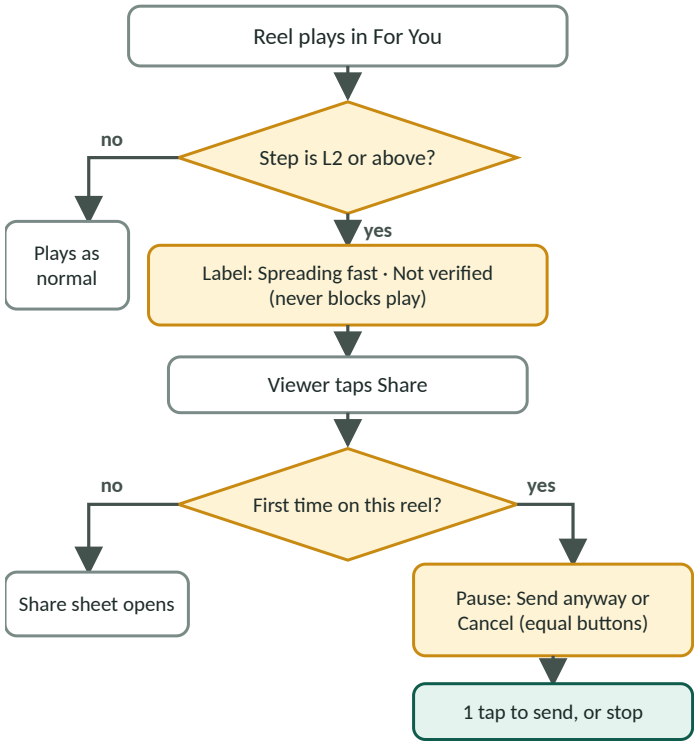
A. Response ladder: every step up needs the score held for 2 runs (10 min) plus its gate; every cut ends on a timer

Solid green arrow: step up. Dashed amber arrow: automatic step-down with its timer.

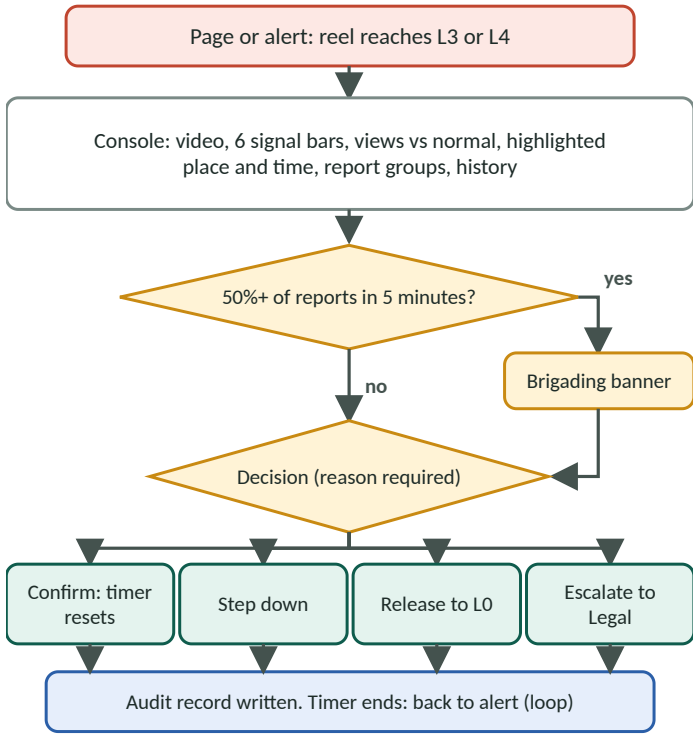


B. Three journeys: viewer, analyst, creator

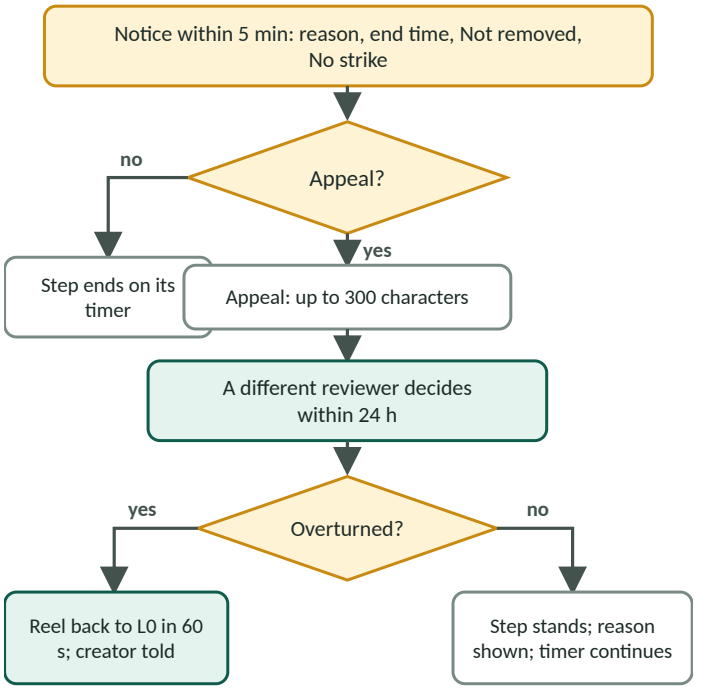
Viewer (FR4, D1)



Analyst (FR6, D3)



Creator (FR8, D4)



8. NON-FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

Area	Requirement	Reason
Latency	Score ready within 60 s of each 5-minute run. A reel reaches the queue within 10 minutes of crossing a band (two runs). A step reaches the recommender in 60 s or less. The label shows within 1 s of video start.	The brief's reel took 72 hours; minutes are fast enough to matter.
Scale	Score only reels that meet the 99.5th-percentile rule (about 1 in 200). Scoring must add no more than 1% to feed latency at p95.	V Keeps cost low at 60M users.
Failure handling	If scoring fails for 15 minutes, page the on-call and freeze: no new automatic step up, existing steps keep running on their timers.	Fail neither open nor closed in silence.
Languages	Hindi and English for the claim and call-to-gather signals. Other languages get velocity and cross-community only, capped at L1.	Fairness gap named: V1 may miss reels in other languages.
Privacy	State-level location only, never GPS or city. Reports stored with hashed account ids. Raw signals deleted after 90 days; audit records kept.	V Legal to confirm.
Security and access	Console limited to T&S reviewers by role. Threshold edits need Policy and Legal approval.	Stops quiet drift of the line.
Auditability	Append-only, hash-chained, exportable in 24 hours, kept 3 years.	V Regulator readiness.

9. SUCCESS METRICS

North star: share of reviewer-confirmed mobilizing reels that are limited (L3 or above) **before 250,000 views**. Target at week 12: **80% or more** V. 250,000 views is 0.4% of 60M users C.

Metric	Definition	Target by week 12
Time to first step	From a confirmed mobilizing reel's first scored run to its first step at L2 or above	median 30 min or less; p90 90 min or less V
Precision at L3+	Share of L3 and L4 reels a second reviewer agrees were correctly limited (all audited weekly)	80% or more V
Over-action	Ordinary viral reels in the top 0.5% by velocity that reach L2+, and L3+	L2+ at most 1%; L3+ at most 0.1% V
Review speed	L4 reviewed within 30 min; L3 within 2 h	95% and 90%
Fairness	Appeals overturned; appeals decided within 24 h	10% or less overturned; 95% in time
Gaming resistance	Score rise from 500 colluding accounts; steps caused by reports alone	3 points or less; 0 steps
Audit completeness	Events with a full record; export time	100%; within 24 h

Guardrails	Total watch time not lower than baseline by more than 0.3% V. Creators who were limited keep 30-day retention within 2 points of matched creators V.
Experiment	**L2 label A/B** (Phase 2): reels in the 55–69 band randomised 50/50. Primary metric: share of reels that pass 500,000 views, expected 30% vs 15% V. Sample: $n = (1.96+0.84)^2 \times [0.30\times0.70 + 0.15\times0.85] \div 0.15^2 = 118$, so **120 reels per arm** (α 0.05, power 0.8) C. If the band yields fewer than 40 reels a week, extend the test to a rolling 6 weeks. **L3 and L4 have no control group**, because holding back a reach cut on a possibly harmful reel is not acceptable; their effect is measured against the Phase 1 shadow-mode baseline.

Rollout

Phase and weeks	What ships	Gate to move on
0. Backtest (0–2)	200 labelled past reels; thresholds locked; mental-model interviews	Catch 45 of 50 at L2+; at most 3 of 150 ordinary reels at L3+
1. Shadow and manual (3–6)	FR1, FR2 (log only), FR5, FR6, FR9. Analysts apply Slow and Hold by hand. Reports collected with weight 0.	Precision at L3+ at 80% or more on hand-applied cases; 95% of L4 reviewed in 30 min
2. Automatic (7–12)	FR3, FR4, FR8 and automatic steps; FR7 weights switch on after 30 days of collection; L2 label A/B	Week-12 targets above; no step caused by reports alone

10. OPEN POINTS

#	Open point	Owner	Needed by
1	Every [V] number in this PRD (99.5th percentile, point weights, 50% cap, timers) is set or changed by the Phase 0 backtest on 200 labelled reels. Where do the labels come from, and who agrees them?	Data science, Policy	Week 2
2	Do interest clusters and state-level location exist in the ranker's data? FR1 depends on both.	Recommender team	Week 1
3	Validate the mental model: 5 analysts, 10 creators, 10 viewers. Test three label wordings with 10 viewers each.	PM, Design	Week 2
4	Staffing for a 30-minute L4 SLA around the clock. How many reviewers per shift, and what does it cost?	T&S head	Week 3
5	Retention periods (3 years audit, 90 days signals) and the regulator export format.	Legal	Week 4
6	Should a verified news account with a source link be fully exempt from the unverified-claim signal? V1 treats it as exempt.	Policy	Week 2
7	Classifier accuracy for Hindi-English mixed text (for example "aaj 6 baje India Gate aao"). Needs its own test set.	Data science	Week 2

SAFEGUARDS AND SECOND-ORDER EFFECTS

Risk	Safeguard in this PRD	See
Throttling legitimate protest or news	Reach is cut only with both content signals. Popular or political reels with neither stop at L1. Verified news with a source link scores 0 on the claim signal. Every cut has a reason shown, a timer and an appeal.	FR2, FR3, FR8
A group gaming the report button	Report groups count once, a burst discount, a 10-point cap, reports cannot lift a reel above L1, weekly red-team (at most 3 points).	FR7
A cut nobody reviews	Automatic step-down and a 24-hour cap without a second reviewer.	FR3
Reviewer error	A second reviewer audits every L3+ case weekly (precision 80% or more). Appeals go to a different person.	FR8
Language bias	Content signals only in Hindi and English; other languages capped at L1 and reported to Policy monthly.	NFR
Creators learn the words and change them	Monthly review of the place, time and claim phrases; the spread signals still show the reel to analysts at L1.	FR1
The label draws attention (backfire)	The L2 A/B watches reach and share rates. If labelled reels pass 500,000 views more often, drop the label.	FR4
Pressure to widen the line to viewpoints	Non-goal: no signal looks at viewpoint. Threshold edits need two approvers and are logged and exportable.	FR9

WOULD V1 HAVE CAUGHT THE BRIEF'S REEL? (ILLUSTRATIVE)

Example numbers to show the arithmetic. Not PulseReel data.

Time after post	Signals (points)	Score	Step
+2 h	velocity 15, cross-community 10, call to gather 20, unverified claim 15	60 [C]	L2 Label (both content signals present)
+4 h	velocity 25, cross-community 20, call to gather 20, claim 15, external share 10	90 [C]	L4 Hold after 2 runs (10 min); reviewer within 30 min
A big dance trend	velocity 25, cross-community 20, external share 10, no content signal	55 [C]	L1 Watch only (gate fails)

Result: the brief's reel is limited about 4 hours after posting, not after 72 hours. A dance trend at the same speed is never limited.

SOURCES: PUBLIC RESEARCH USED IN THIS PRD

All S items are public. Figures are as reported by each source; company figures are marked as company figures.

#	Source and date	What it says	How this PRD uses it
[1]	**MIT Technology Review on Vosoughi, Roy and Aral, Science** 25 Apr 2018 https://www.technologyreview.com/2018/04/25/143295/false-news-flies-faster	About 126,000 Twitter cascades (2006–2017). False stories were about 70% more likely to be retweeted; true stories took about 6x as long to reach 1,500 people. Bots were not the main cause.	Waiting for facts is too slow (pain point 3). It studies text on Twitter, so it shows direction, not a PulseReel rate.
[2]	**Al Jazeera, "WhatsApp curbs India services after spate of lynchings"** 20 Jul 2018 https://www.aljazeera.com/amp/news/2018/7/20/whatsapp-curbs-india-services-after-spate-of-lynchings	WhatsApp capped forwards at 5 chats in India after more than two dozen people were beaten to death by mobs following false child-kidnapping messages. India's IT ministry had called for curbs.	Why a wrong call is costly in India; precedent for friction at the share step.
[3]	**TechCrunch on WhatsApp's limit on highly forwarded messages** 27 Apr 2020 https://techcrunch.com/2020/04/27/whatsapps-new-limit-cuts-virality-of-highly-forwarded-messages-by-70	From 7 Apr 2020 highly forwarded messages can go to one chat at a time. WhatsApp reported a 70% global drop. The article notes the term is undefined and the figure is the company's.	Starting point for the reach cap (FR5). V1 starts milder, at 50%.
[4]	**TechCrunch, "Twitter plans to bring prompts to 'read before you retweet' to all users"** 24 Sep 2020 https://techcrunch.com/2020/09/24/twitter-read-before-retweet	Twitter reported users were 40% more likely to open an article before sharing with the prompt, and among those who opened it, 33% more retweets. Company figures.	Supports the share pause (FR4). It is tested by the L2 A/B before relying on it.
[5]	**Fortune on Facebook's viral content review system** 18 Oct 2020 https://fortune.com/2020/10/18/facebook-tool-stop-fake-news-viral-content-review-system-fb-business-model	Facebook's viral content review system reduces a post's distribution while it is checked, and does not remove it. No thresholds or usage were published.	Precedent for slowing instead of removing. It publishes no thresholds, so every number here is our own V1 setting, tested in Phase 0.
[6]	**UCA News, "Nepal PM quits after deadly protests sparked by social media ban"** Sept 2025 https://www.ucanews.com/amp/nepal-pm-quits-after-deadly-protests-sparked-by-social-media-ban/110229	Protests began 8 Sept, led largely by people in their 20s; at least 19 died; the prime minister resigned on 9 Sept. The trigger was a government ban on social media platforms.	Shows how fast youth-led protest can escalate. It is an analogy: a different trigger and country.
[7]	**Business Today on IAMAI "Internet in India Report 2025"** 29 Jan 2026 https://www.businesstoday.in/technology/news/story/indias-internet-user-base-tops-950-million-as-rural-growth-ai-drive-adoption-513353-2026-01-29	588 million people consume short-form video, about 61% of India's internet population, with the strongest adoption among younger audiences.	Scale of the audience (problem statement).

Inputs from the brief

60M Indian users aged 18–25; one unverified incident reel became a nationwide protest movement within 72 hours; rising government scrutiny of algorithmic amplification; PulseReel's leadership wants fast-mobilizing content handled differently from ordinary viral content.

V1 settings V (final values set by the Phase 0 backtest)

The 99.5th and 99.9th percentile cut-offs · the six point weights · 8 clusters and 10 states · the 50% cap · all timers (2 h, 12 h, 4 h, 60 min, 24 h) · the report-weight limits (30 days, 20 reels, 30 groups, x0.2, 60% overturn) · 250,000 views · 80% and 1% targets · the 200-reel backtest set · 3-year and 90-day retention.

Frameworks applied

Problem statement template and **5 Whys** (page 1), **segments** by persona (pages 2 and 4), **trade-offs** and **second-order effects** (pages 4 and 8), **north star, KPIs and guardrails** (page 7), **A/B test with sample-size arithmetic** and **holdout rules** (page 7), **PRD Co-Pilot structure**: sections 1–10 in order.